Stellar Cyber 6.6.0s is now live! Discover all the updates in the release notes!

Configuring Active Directory Connectors

Learn more at Stellar Cyber Academy.

The following link takes you to a course on the Stellar Cyber Academy technical training portal where you can learn more about this topic by watching the suggested lessons.

M03 Modular Sensor Concepts and Configuration (08h:56m)

AD Connector Collection of Asset and User Details (12m:00s)

Discover how the Active Directory (AD) connector collects asset and user details for enhanced visibility in the Stellar Cyber Platform. Learn how to manage and integrate AD attributes to enable detailed investigations and user behavior analysis.

AD Connector Response Actions to Disable a User (42m:00s)

Learn to use the AD connector for response actions, including disabling user accounts directly from the Stellar Cyber Platform. Follow a demonstration of how this action integrates with incident response workflows, and explore configurations for streamlining user access management as part of a comprehensive response strategy.

The first time you access a link on the portal during a session, you must log in to access content.

This connector allows Stellar Cyber to ingest logs from Active Directory (AD) and add the records to the data lake and, optionally, to issue the Disable User response action.

Active Directory integration with Stellar Cyber enables organizations to monitor and detect security threats across their network, including domain controllers, workstations, and servers, while providing quick case response capabilities.

We recommend that you configure an Active Directory connector. It provides the following key capabilities:

- The user information from AD enriches event Interflow records and provides user profile details for User Behavior Analytics.

- The computer information from AD supports Windows Event Collector (WEC), which lets one server forward the Windows Event logs belonging to several Windows machines.
- Stellar Cyber can be configured to use this connector to disable AD users that have been identified as a security risk.

The Active Directory Disable User response action supports disabling users with any field having the following values:

- username of the format `username`
- sid of the format `S-1-5-21-XXXXXXXXX-XXXXXXXXXX-XXXXXXXXX-XXXX`
- user principal of the format `username@domain.tld`

Stellar Cyber connectors with the Collect function (collectors) may skip collecting some data when the ingestion volume is large, which potentially can lead to data loss. This can happen when the processing capacity of the collector is exceeded.

Connector Overview: Active Directory

Capabilities

- Collect: **Yes**
- Respond: **Yes**
- Native Alerts Mapped: **No**
- Runs on: **DP** (Respond) or **Sensor** (Collect and Respond)
- Interval: **Configurable**

Collected Data

Content Type	Index	Locating Records

Computers
Users
	Windows Events
	Assets (for Computers)
		msg_class:
		`AD_computer`
		`AD_user_profile`
		
		msg_origin.source:
		`active_directory`
		
		msg_origin.vendor:
		`microsoft`
		
		msg_origin.category:

Content Type	Index	Locating Records
		`iam`

Domain

<Server Hostname>

where <Server Hostname> is a variable from the configuration of this connector

Response Actions

Action	Required Fields
Disable User	`userPrincipalName`

The Active Directory responder does not support Kerberos authentication, only the collector does.

There are two other ways to disable an Active Directory user:

- Navigate to **Automation | Action History** and choose the **User Actions** tab. See Create a Disable User Action.
- Navigate to **Assets | User Behavior Analytics** and choose the **Users** tab. See Disable a User Action.

Third Party Native Alert Integration Details

N/A

Required Credentials and Configurations

- Active Directory Domain, Server Hostname, User Name, and Password, plus Protocol Type (LDAP, LDAPS, or LDAPS (certificate validation disabled))

  If you select **LDAPS**, refer to **Configuring Certificates for AD Connectors with LDAPS** for details on how to upload and apply a certificate to the sensor running the connector.

- In addition, for Kerberos Protocol Type: Realm Name, KDC, Admin Server, and Default Domain
- For the Active Directory collector running on Sensor, AD server must be added to the Sensor DNS

Adding an Active Directory Connector

To add an Active Directory connector:

1. Obtain and verify Active Directory requirements
2. Add the connector in Stellar Cyber
3. Test the connector
4. Verify ingestion

Obtaining and Verifying Active Directory Requirements

To configure an Active Directory Stellar Cyber connector, you will need the following information:

- The Active Directory domain to be monitored

- The fully qualified domain name (FQDN) or IP address for an Active Directory Server configured as a Domain Controller
- The protocol type (LDAP, LDAPS, or LDAPS with certificate validation disabled)
- (Optional) To support authentication using Kerberos, you will need an AD Server with Kerberos enabled and you will also need a Kerberos server
- Active Directory username and passwords with appropriate permissions
- For the Active Directory collector running on Sensor, you need to add the AD server to the Sensor DNS

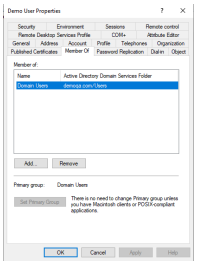
To set up the LDAPS protocol or Kerberos over LDAPS, refer to the Microsoft documentation and **Configuring Certificates for AD Connectors with LDAPS**. For example, look in Active Directory documentation to troubleshoot Active Directory-related issues.

The Windows Server 2025 functional level may enforce the use of LDAPS. You may need to enable LDAPS to comply with this functional level. Refer to the Microsoft documentation for Active Directory Domain Services functional levels.

The permissions for the Stellar Cyber Active Directory **Respond** function are greater than for the **Collect** function. You may, optionally, set up two different connector instances for different purposes, if you want to use different user accounts for the Stellar Cyber collection and response purposes.

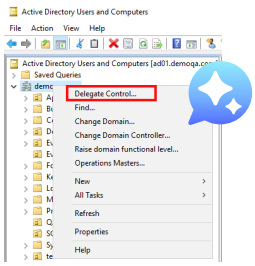
- **For Collect only** configurations, the username and password needs to be a standard Active Directory user who is a member of the domain to be monitored.

  The password should not include non-ASCII special characters.

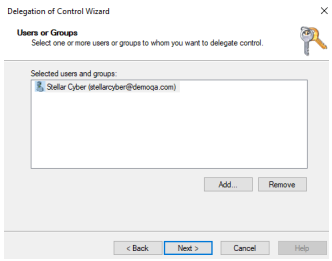
  

- **For Respond** configurations, follow the steps below to ensure the account is configured appropriately.

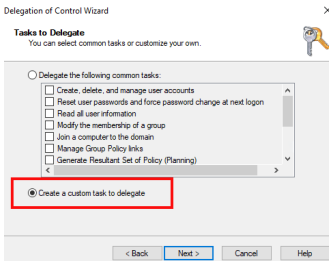
  1. Launch **Active Directory Users and Computers** with administrative credentials.
  2. Right click on the **Organizational Unit** with the user account for which you want to enable the respond action authority, and select **Delegate Control**.



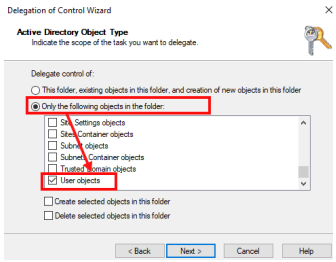
3. Select the **user or group** to which you want to delegate the authority, then press **Next**.



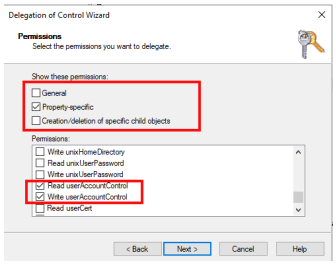
4. Select **Create Custom Task to Delegate** and press **Next**.



5. In the **Delegation of Control Wizard**, select the radio button for **Only the following objects in the folder**.



6. Check the box for **User objects**, then press **Next**.
7. In the Permissions panel section for **Show these permissions**, uncheck **General** and check **Property-specific**.

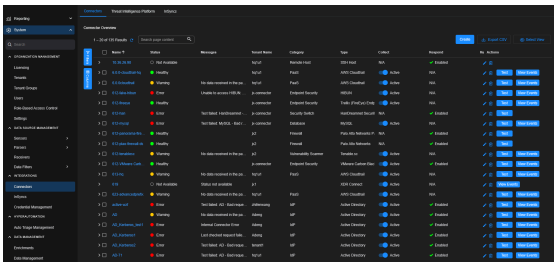


8. In the specific permissions section, check the boxes for `Read userAccountControl` and `Write userAccountControl`.
9. Click **Next**, and then **Finish**.

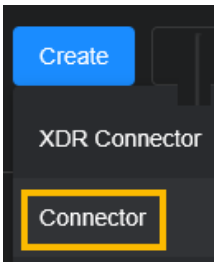
Adding the Connector in Stellar Cyber

To add an Active Directory connector in Stellar Cyber:

1. Log in to Stellar Cyber.
2. Click **System | INTEGRATIONS | Connectors**. The **Connector Overview** appears.

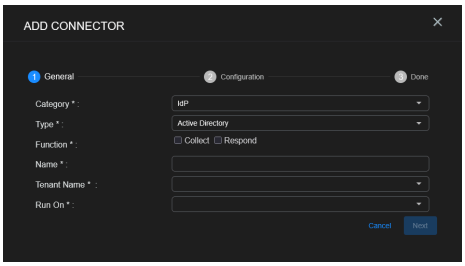


3. Click **Create** and select **Connector**.



The **General** tab of the **Add Connector** screen appears. The information on this tab cannot be changed after you add the connector.

4. Choose **IdP** from the **Category** dropdown.
5. Choose **Active Directory** from the **Type** dropdown.



The asterisk (*) indicates a required field.

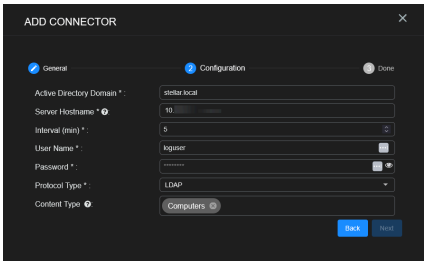
6. For **Function**, enable **Collect**. If you want to be able to disable users, also check the box for **Respond**.
7. Enter a **Name**.

Notes:

- This field does not accept multibyte characters.
- It is recommended that you follow a naming convention such as tenantname-connectortype.

8. Choose a **Tenant Name**. The Interflow records created by this connector include this tenant name.
9. Choose the device on which to run the connector.

10. (Optional) When the **Function** is **Collect**, you can apply **Log Filters**. For information, see Managing Log Filt
11. Click **Next**. The **Configuration** tab appears.



The asterisk (*) indicates a required field.

12. Enter the **Active Directory Domain** to be monitored, for example, stellar.local.
13. Enter the **Server Hostname**, which is the fully qualified domain name (FQDN) or IP address for an Active Directory Server configured as a Domain Controller.

    Do not include https in the hostname.

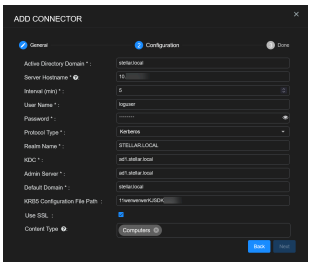
14. Enter the **Interval (min)**. This is how often the logs are collected.
15. Enter the **User Name** for AD authentication. See the above section for guidance on permissions for the user account required to collect and respond.
16. Enter the **Password**.
17. Choose the applicable **Protocol Type**: **LDAP**, **LDAPS**, **LDAPS (certificate validation disabled)**, or **Kerberos**.

    If you select **LDAPS**, refer to **Configuring Certificates for AD Connectors with LDAPS** for details on how to upload and apply a certificate to the sensor running the connector.

    Note the following for **Kerberos**:

    - You can only configure one Active Directory connector with Kerberos on each Sensor.
    - Respond actions in Active Directory are also supported with Kerberos authentication. However, selecting Data Processor in the **Run On** field in the General tab of the **Add Connector** screen is not supported. 6.4.0
    - If you enable channel rebinding, you must select **Kerberos** for the **Protocol Type**. By default, NTLM is used, but if you enable channel rebinding, you must enable **Kerberos**.

18. (Optional) If you selected **Kerberos**, the configuration tab has more fields:



The asterisk (*) indicates a required field.

a. Enter the **Realm Name**. This is your Kerberos realm in uppercase, for example, STELLAR.LOCAL.

b. Enter the **KDC**. This is the name or address of a host running a Key Distribution Center (KDC) for that realm. In most cases, the **KDC** is the same as the **Server Hostname**.

c. Enter the **Admin Server**. This is the host where the administration server is running. Typically, this is the master Kerberos server.

d. Enter the **Default Domain**. This is the Kerberos realm name for a particular host or domain.

e. (Optional) Enter the **KRB5 Configuration File Path**. This is the customized krb5.conf file for Kerberos authentication. For example, a file path might be /etc/krb5.conf, which indicates the file path on a sensor. (You may need Customer Support's assistance to upload the file to the sensor.) If a customized krb5.conf file is not specified, the default conf file is used.

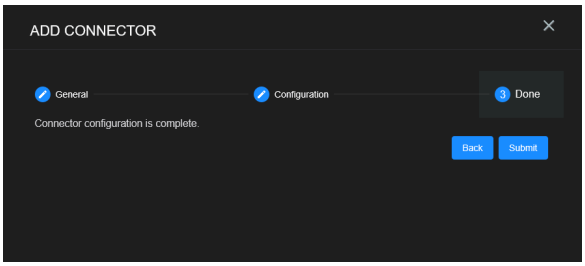
f. (Optional) Select **Use SSL** to use SSL. It is enabled by default. Deselect the checkbox to not use SSL with **Kerberos**.

19. (Optional) Choose the **Content Type**. The logs for **Computers** are supported. (The logs for **Users** are also supported, but they are hard coded and cannot be selected from the user interface.)

Stellar Cyber queries computers using LDAP, enriches them with IP address information through DNS, and populates the Windows Events index.

In addition, the computers are sent to the **Assets | Asset Analytics** page.

20. Click **Next**. The final confirmation tab appears.



21. Click **Submit**.

The new connector is immediately active and collects up to 90 days of activity stored in the AD server.

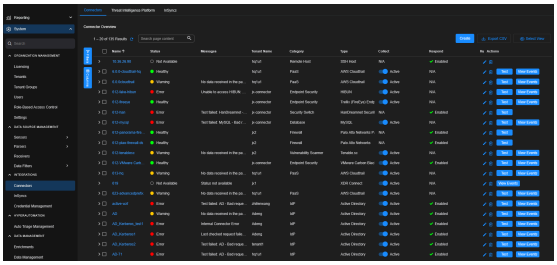
Testing the Connector

If you're running the Active Directory connector on a Sensor, make sure that the Sensor and DP are running the same version of software. Otherwise the test might not work.

When you add (or edit) a connector, we recommend that you run a test to validate the connectivity parameters you entered. The test validates authentication and connectivity.

For connectors running on a sensor, Stellar Cyber recommends that you allow 30-60 seconds for new or modified configuration details to be propagated to the sensor before performing a test.

1. Click **System | INTEGRATIONS | Connectors**. The **Connector Overview** appears.



2. Locate the connector by name that you added, or modified, or that you want to test.
3. Click **Test** at the right side of that row. The test runs immediately.

   Note that you may run only one test at a time.

Stellar Cyber conducts a basic connectivity test for the connector and reports a success or failure result. A successful test indicates that you entered all of the connector information correctly.

To aid troubleshooting your connector, the dialog remains open until you explicitly close it by using the **X** button. If the test fails, you can select the button from the same row to review and correct issues.

The connector status is updated every five (5) minutes. A successful test clears the connector status, but if issues persist, the status reverts to failed after a minute.

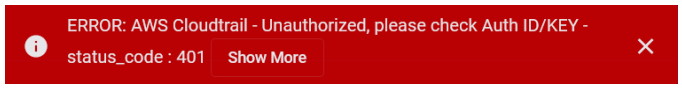
Repeat the test as needed.

Display sample messages...

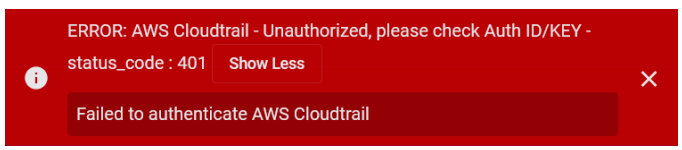
Success !



Failure with summary of issue:



Show More example detail:



If the test fails, the common HTTP status error codes are as follows:

HTTP Error Code	HTTP Standard Error Name	Explanation	Recommendation
400	Bad Request	This error occurs when there is an error in the connector configuration.	Did you configure the connector correctly?
401	Unauthorized	This error occurs when an authentication credential is invalid or when a user does not have sufficient privileges to access a specific API.	Did you enter your credentials correctly? Are your credentials expired? Are your credentials entitled or licensed for that specific resource?
403	Forbidden	This error occurs when the permission or scope is not correct in a valid credential.	Did you enter your credentials correctly? Do you have the required role or permissions for that credential?
404	Not Found	This error occurs when a URL path does not resolve to an entity.	Did you enter your API URL correctly?
429	Too Many Requests	This error occurs when the API server receives too much traffic or if a user's license or entitlement quota is exceeded.	The server or user license/quota will eventually recover. The connector will periodically retry the query. If this occurs unexpectedly or too often, work with your API provider to investigate the server limits, user licensing, or quotas.

For a full list of codes, refer to HTTP response status codes.

Verifying Ingestion

To verify ingestion:

1. Select **Threat Hunting**.

   The **Interflow Search** tab appears.

2. Change the **Indices** for the type of content you collected:
   - For **Computers** and **Users**, change the **Indices** to **Windows Events**.
   - For **Computers** only, change the **Indices** to **Assets**.

   The table immediately updates to show ingested Interflow records.

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